

Tobias Treppmann

Token layering, parity held in the repository, and prototypes engineering ships from

CONTACT

LOCATION

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design systems and tokens

DTCG tokens in four tiers · primitive against semantic naming as a control surface · Style Dictionary · Storybook as the source of truth · Figma as a consumer of the repository · multi-platform token pipelines · component APIs and specifications · custom easing curves as system tokens

Code and tooling

Prototyping in production code against real APIs · HTML, CSS and JavaScript by hand · design-system pull request review · six enforcement checks running identically locally and in CI · a token suggestion engine bounded to the property's own family · an exception register that sets the roadmap

Agentic practice

Claude Code daily for over a year · agentic engineering introduced where the practice did not exist · token vocabularies handed to an assistant as enumerated lists · a production support copilot · an end-to-end AI fundraising system · taught to another company's designers and developers

Leading the discipline

Five design leadership tenures · design system ownership with cross-functional governance · a decade mentoring and coaching designers · research methodology built rather than inherited · enterprise interfaces under regulation

PROFILE

Head of Product Design at Bibel TV, where I built the token architecture and work in the repository it ships from. Token layering runs four tiers in DTCG format, serving iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source. Parity between design source and code is held the way round most teams do not attempt. The repository is the source and Figma consumes it. I define the requirements and build the tools that keep quality and consistency across design and code. My prototypes are written in production code against real APIs, and an external engineering agency ships from them.

Repository first

the repo is the source and Figma consumes it — parity held rather than maintained

Six checks, one command

identical locally and in CI, so off-system work fails before review

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- The design system is mine end to end. I took the initiative on it, and nobody who builds with it reports to me.
- Token layering in four tiers, primitive against semantic decided rather than inherited. Primitives are fixed and semantic carries the contract.
- The component and page tiers alias downward and add no new values. A control surface, not a taxonomy.
- A product team changes a component's spacing without an agency release. Server-driven UI is the direction that opens.
- Parity between design source and code, with the dependency inverted. The repository is the source and Figma consumes it.
- Storybook is what engineers and product managers build against.
- Audited all thirty web components against the native apps they mirror. A card's fallback gradient aliased one layer too deep in light mode.
- The app drew a soft ramp and the web drew flat white. Nothing looked broken, which is why nobody had seen it.
- Defined the requirements and built the tools that hold that consistency — six checks, one command, identical locally and in CI.
- Two reject what I watched an assistant produce. A reference to a token that does not exist, and a color, size or duration written straight into a component.
- Both compile and both render. Neither is catchable by reading, so the check is the only thing that can catch them.
- Constrained the token suggestion engine after it offered a spacing token for a 12px font size. The numbers matched and it would have rendered pixel-identical.
- It would also have welded body text to the gap between two cards. Suggestions are bounded to the property's own family now.
- Where no token qualifies the check says nothing at all. A confidently wrong suggestion is worse than none for someone who does not know the catalog.
- The token vocabulary is handed to an assistant as an enumerated list rather than recalled, so the compliant path is also the fastest one.
- Prototype in production code against real APIs, and the engineering agency ships from that code. That handoff crosses a company boundary.
- Prototyped on Android because Android is the largest part of the userbase, not because the tooling was fastest there.
- The Android prototype is my source of truth.
- Investigating a stakeholder's worry about gradients on old Android screens showed the banding was a function of old displays, not of the platform.
- We ship multi-step gradients now, including for monochrome ones, where nobody had asked for it.
- The color engine was my initiative, generated and carried forward to release. It derives a theme per artwork in OKLCH, across a catalog past ten thousand videos.
- WCAG contrast is validated inside the algorithm rather than checked afterwards, so no theme can ship failing it.
- Explored the concept with a broader audience before committing to it. 87% preferred light mode and premium feel rated 4.2 out of 5 (n=40).
- The engine produces two text colors. On a dense phone display one tested better, so it ships with one.
- Review design-system pull requests on the tokens, Storybook and the web components.
- Introduced agentic engineering here where the practice did not exist. Claude Code has been the daily tool for over a year.
- Taught it outside as well. A workshop series on AI for design and prototyping ran for a Polish agency's own designers and developers, late 2025 into January 2026.
- A production support copilot came out of that practice, and an AI fundraising system built end to end.
- Warmth is the point of the brand, so the experience has to feel it. Light mode was the bet.

- Delight here is restraint. Two text colors were available and one shipped.
- Figma is documentation. The prototype is the argument.
- Every decision above was made in running code.
- Nobody reviews this system. That is why it checks itself.
- The repo is the source. Figma follows.
- Six checks. One command.
- It compiles. It renders. It is still wrong.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Led all product design across the company, and held product management for the main platform alongside it.
- Managed the booking project from proposal through execution and release. One build carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings, and shipped to every customer.
- 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance. Building it into the platform rather than bolting it on was the decision that made those numbers possible.
- An accessibility law landed on customers who host their sites with us. We audited ours and theirs against the European Accessibility Act.
- Shipped the capability that met it for them automatically, across six countries under GDPR plus church data-protection law.
- Six countries, one build.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Owned the design system and built its governance — a cross-functional working group with a design lead and an engineering lead.
- The contribution process was documented, so a change had a route rather than a habit.
- Ran design and product simultaneously for four months, nine people across design, UX writing, product management and data science.
- On the senior leadership team. Hired two, promoted two.
- Half that team wrote rather than designed. The style guide and content system were built with them, so voice was a shared standard rather than per-screen taste.
- Two disciplines, four months.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Defined how components behaved across the shared library: what each one guaranteed, and where it could be used.
- Built research methodology that did not exist, screening iteratively to reach analysts inside banks and insurers the panels could not.
- Qualitative research drove the decisions on a platform where the users were unreachable by ordinary recruiting.
- Led the design team across Germany and New York. Five years of enterprise interfaces under regulation.
- Remote across two time zones for five years, on camera in every meeting.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade mentoring and coaching designers

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport hub SE* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin / Lübeck · listed group, holacracy

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany · 200+ people, international e-commerce

Earlier · *UX Manager, UX Designer, Web Developer* · 2009 – 2014 · Pennsylvania, USA